

Vertigo

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NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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Alex Ravens leading "It's Alright Ma (I'm only bolting) (Grade 17)",
Leonard Cohen Memorial Buttress, Tukino. [More here](#)

Chair's Report

March 2018

Risk aversion in the outdoors (and other contexts) has increasingly been replacing risk management such that, being exposed to any risk, is considered all but unacceptable, particularly when it comes to climbing. Oddly this doesn't apply to getting into a car (398 driving related deaths last year) or heart disease (every 90 min a New Zealander dies from heart disease) among other more accepted forms of killing yourself.

In contrast more people than ever are signing up for rock climbing and alpine courses. You might argue that this is a good thing as they will gain valuable experience and knowledge about how to keep themselves safe in the outdoors. But courses are invariably short and intensive, delivered over a few weeks after which participants can take on whatever they like. The Wellington Section summer rock course takes two months to complete and combines multiple intensive indoor theory and practical sessions, both in and outdoors. Our winter snowcraft courses take a slightly different approach, breaking up the levels of ability into smaller chunks that are delivered over a three year period, with the expectation that between each course participants spend time practicing their new skills and gaining valuable experience.

What we have noticed from this approach is that, unless returning participants did find time to practice what they had learnt in the course, they weren't ready to take on the next stage and needed to repeat what they had done. This is a good thing as we are able to catch the people who need additional or repeat training. We have also been receiving applications from people who had done one off commercial courses that have no follow up, leaving the participant with an expectation that they are competent climbers. There is no substitute for experience. Courses provide very little experience. An advantage of spacing out our snowcraft courses is that it allows participants time to get the necessary experience, which is possible by joining section trips. We get excellent feedback on our courses, which is great, but they are no substitute for time on the mountain.

"Kids need to learn that you need to feel bad sometimes. We learn through experience, and we learn especially through bad experiences."

Jean M. Twenge, iGen: Why Today's Super-Connected Kids Are Growing Up Less Rebellious, More Tolerant, Less Happy -- and Completely Unprepared for Adulthood -- and What That Means for the Rest of Us.

If you have any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Simon

From the Editor

Thanks to those who've recently sent in trip reports and images. Please keep em coming. Let's share more of our adventures. Just type up a report of between half a page to three pages as a Word document, email it to me at occasionalclimber@gmail.com with one to six jpeg images and I'll format it for Vertigo.

Don't forget the page quicklinks at the base of each page - they let you go straight to the page you want rather than having to scroll back and forth all the time.

Peter

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

April Section night

From 6pm Wed 25th April, Rohan Light will talk to us about risk management and decision making in the field.

Rohan's talk will be an adaptation of the strategic thinking class he teaches, slanted towards some of the decision making issues people face in the field. Since his last presentation, Rohan has done some work with NZSAR and paramedics on decision making in the field. He has also worked with DoC on the same topic.

All Section night talks are held at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery, level 2.

Section nights beyond April

From 6pm Wed 30th May, Marcus Thomas will present his spectacular Cave book.

From 6pm Wed 27th June, Steven Fortune will take us on some new routes in Khumbu, Nepal. TBC

From 6pm Wed 25th July, Ross Cullen will take us through three years of Norwegian scrambling and climbing.

From 6pm Wed 29th August, it's the annual Wellington Section Photo competition judging evening.

From 6pm Wed 26th September, Penny Webster will take us through her quest to climb all of New Zealand's 3,000m peaks.

From 6pm Wed 31st October, Nigel Roberts will present his journey up the highest peaks in each of USA's 50 states.

From 6pm Wed 28th November, Nina Sawicki will take us on a journey to Kanchenjunga base camp in Nepal.



Fungi, Kahurangi National Park

Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#).

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.

Updating our Club's history

A request for any updates from Club history buffs out there.

Past and Current Presidents list:

- Anyone know the dates of death for - Leonard Harper's (Pres 1891); Frank Graham (Pres 1895); J T Meeson (Pres 1896 also his first name)?
- Any name/info on G J McCallum (Pres 1979) and Dr R G Cunninghame (Press May-Aug 1981)?

Any missing name/date of passing details for our first 50yr Veterans, the Foundation Members who achieved 50yr status on the following [webpage](#)? Also if you are able to fill in any gaps from the PDF lists at the bottom of this webpage it would be greatly appreciated.

Please contact [Margaret](#) if you can fill in any details.

Heading to Mt Cupola, Nelson Lakes

Notices

NZAC 2018 calendars now on sale

Order [here](#). Please note buying online will have postage added at the checkout.

Aspiring Hut closes 9 April for earthquake strengthening

50 Year Veteran Members

Congratulations to our latest group of NZAC members who have now attained 50 Year Veteran Membership status.

- William Atkinson, Jocelyn Douglas and Keith Woodford of the Canterbury/Westland Section
- E Ross Beech, Edward Ford and E Brin Williman of Nelson/Marlborough
- Conway Powell of Otago
- Gary Brehaut of South Canterbury
- Roy Heiskel of Southland

The Club also thanks these members for their loyalty to the New Zealand Alpine Club. A full list of current and past Veteran 50yr members can be viewed [here](#).

Broken River Skifield – Winter 2018 Member Discount

A new discount for NZAC members is now available for the upcoming season. Find out more [here](#).

International Snow Science Workshop preliminary programme [here](#)

American Alpine Club 2018 International Climbers' Meet, Yosemite Valley

The American Alpine Club is hosting its 10th annual International Climbers' Meet (ICM), to be held the week of Oct 7th - Oct 14th, 2018 in Yosemite Valley. There will be three days of education programming, host climbers available for guidance, and, per usual, an international cast of characters that will be crushing Yosemite. More [here](#).

UIAA ice climbing season

The provisional calendar for the 2018 UIAA Ice Climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#).

“Berg”, 1962-2002

Free to good home - German Alpine Club journals, “Berg”, 1962-2002 - in German. Contact Anne Braun-Elwert - climb@alpinerecreation.com

Most Wanted – Images

The Department of Conservation needs great photos of particular huts, campsites, tracks and places. Many of their web pages are text only, but a picture can say so much more. Please take a look at their [most-wanted list](#), then follow the guidelines to submit your pics.

NZAC also would like both recent and/or historical images of its huts and more prominent members for use online and elsewhere. External and Interior images greatly appreciated and can be emailed to [Margaret](#). Please check out the [Heritage area](#) of our website to see where we are lacking images and supply image credit details to confirm we have permission to publish.

Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What & where
20 - 22 April 2018	Rock climbing meet at Tukino Ski Field, staying at TASC lodge. Register your interest by emailing Eric Duggan or phone him 021 350 161
July, specific date TBC	Avalanche Awareness Course presented by Aviette Musin - the ideal precursor to a Snowcraft Course or any winter alpine activities
Friday 27th & Saturday 28th July	Beginner Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 3rd & Saturday 4th Aug	Beginner Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 17th & Saturday 18th Aug	Beginner/Intermediate Winter Snowcraft Course
Friday 24th & Saturday 25th Aug	Intermediate/Advanced Winter Snowcraft Course To register for any of these courses click here or contact wellington@alpineclub.org.nz



Snow craft 2018 ... Don't miss out!

Find out more and submit your registration [here](#)



Trip Reports

NZAC Climbing Camp: 3-6 Feb 2018: Tukino

A photo essay - images Margaret Ortega, words and captions Eric Duggan

This image, Luca Wiles leading “It’s Alright Ma (I’m only bolting)” (Grade 17)”
Leonard Cohen Memorial Buttress



1

2

3

4

1 and 2, David Sheppard
First ascent of Sleep Talking (V3)
The Sleep Boulder

3 and 4, David Sheppard
Attempting unclimbed project
The Sleep Boulder



Miles Jones, climbing Spook Fest (V2)
The Sleep Boulder



Bryce Williams, first ascent of Spook Fest (V2)
The Sleep Boulder

The camp saw 38 people on Saturday night and 25 on Sunday and Monday night at TASC lodge at Tukino Ski field on Mt Ruapehu. The first day had the mountain enveloped in mist and drizzle, and no wind to blow it away! It was a great day on the Sunday though, and Monday and Tuesday, although not as fine, were still perfectly climbable, although a bit windy!

Richard Knott, Sandy Britain, and Fran Watling were responsible for some new climbs at Leonard Cohen and Rolling Stones Crag and also a stunning 3 star 3 pitch route on the Southern Buttresses. See climbnz.org.nz for details.

On the Sunday Sandy and Fran, along with Simon Williamson, had led a trad course which was well received by all who attended it. Helen Chapman and Jane Dudley also put up a new route at Leonard Cohen Crag and Jenny Cossey and Paul Clarke did a couple of new routes on the Childs Buttress.

There were a couple of new boulder problems established with Bryce Williams, sending Spook Fest (V2) and David Shepperd, sending Sleep Talking (V3), which no one else could repeat. These were both on the Sleep Boulder near Aorangi Lodge. David Shepperd and others were also trying a hard problem on the Sleep Boulder with a staunch mantle after a sit start, which is still waiting to be sent!

Eric Duggan abseiling "The Jog Along Route (Grade 19)"
Master Angus Wall



Birdlife resurgence in Kahurangi National Park

Just back from a week in Kahurangi National Park. Happy to report that, in all my trips into New Zealand’s back country, I’ve never seen such a variety or proliferation of native birdlife in one place. Robins and Weka everywhere. Blue ducks, Fantail, Tui, Bellbird, Kereru, Tomtit, Kea, Kakariki. Normally you need to pause and tune in to hear birdsong in our forests, but not this time – it was constantly all around me. I’m told that Kahurangi National Park is one of the areas longest receiving 1080 drops. Seems to me that my experience is anecdotal proof that it’s working? Pity about the wasps though. I’ve never seen more of them in one place before either. And, unlike the Robins, they’re not friendly - Peter Laurenson.



Blue ducks, not only in the rivers, but on the tracks as well!



The result of a wasp nest encounter on the trail (if you can call it that) below Baton Saddle

Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Secretary, gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Trip co-ordinator	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Section nights, Vertigo, Photocomp	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Social media	Marie Kelly	
Club liaison	Keith Munro	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
General Committee	Matt Pemberton	
General Committee	Guy Dubuis	
General Committee	Joshua Mouat	
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893



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Shed 6 Queens Wharf
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www.fergskayaks.co.nz

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Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10



New routes every week*

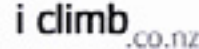
\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



HangDog Rock Climbing Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz
www.hangdog.co.nz



Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer



Ocelot
\$115



MXC 820
\$230



Makalu
\$255



Caiman
\$230

all crampons include anti-balling plates and crampon bag



i climb .co.nz



For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code

WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1- 3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building lifelong friendships

... protecting and improving access to alpine places

... sustaining and growing climbing and mountaineering achievement

... enhancing alpine safety

... building appreciation, enjoyment and protection of alpine places